



Spike protruded from spur, worn on the heel by the knight



▲ PRICK SPUR

Date 11th century

Origin Europe

Material Iron

The prick spur had a single iron spike to guide the horse by prodding its flank. It was the most common form of spur until the introduction of the rowel spur in the late 13th century, which featured multiple points.

▲ LANCE HEAD

Date 12th–13th century

Origin Europe

Weight 90g (3oz)

Length 19.4cm (7½in)

Long lances were used as shock weapons after a charge in combat or in a tournament. Metal combat lance heads, such as this one, could pierce gaps in plate armour, leaving terrible wounds.

► CUISSE AND POLEYN

Date 16th century

Origin Europe

Material Steel

The cuisse was a plate that protected the lower thigh, fastened in place with buckles. It first became common in the 14th century and was sometimes made of two separate plates, which allowed for greater flexibility. The poleyn protected the knee.



Straps for attaching to leg

Lower part attaches above knee joint

Gothic-style mounted knight's armour

Segmented plate criniere to protect neck

Spike protruding from roundel

Shaffron to protect face

Crinet plate for neck

Peytral to protect chest

Diamond-section protruding pick at the back

Leaf-shaped top spike

► WAR-HAMMER

Date c.1490

Origin Europe

Weight 1.51kg (3¼lb)

Length 69.5cm (27½in)

War-hammers appeared around 1250, and were especially popular during the Hundred Years' War (1337–1453). They typically comprised a blunt hammer head or set of claws at the front with a sharp pick at the back.

Flat diamond-shaped hammer face

◀ BARDING

Date c.1480

Origin Northern Europe

Material Steel

Barding, or horse armour, was little used before the 13th century. Initially, it consisted of a simple shaffron of mail to protect the horse's face. Later, plates of "cuir-bouilli" (hardened leather) or metal appeared as peytrals for the chest, and flanchards for the flanks. This is an elaborately decorated Gothic-style barding.

◀ BRONZE MACE

Date 14th century

Origin Europe

Length (Head) 8cm (3¼in)

The mace was a club-like weapon with a metal head. This simple mace consists of a circular bronze head – with vertical ridges or flanges – and a thick wooden shaft. After around 1470, the shafts were also made of metal. Like the war-hammer, maces were popular with cavalymen.

